

Brick Title (as it will appear in the menu) :

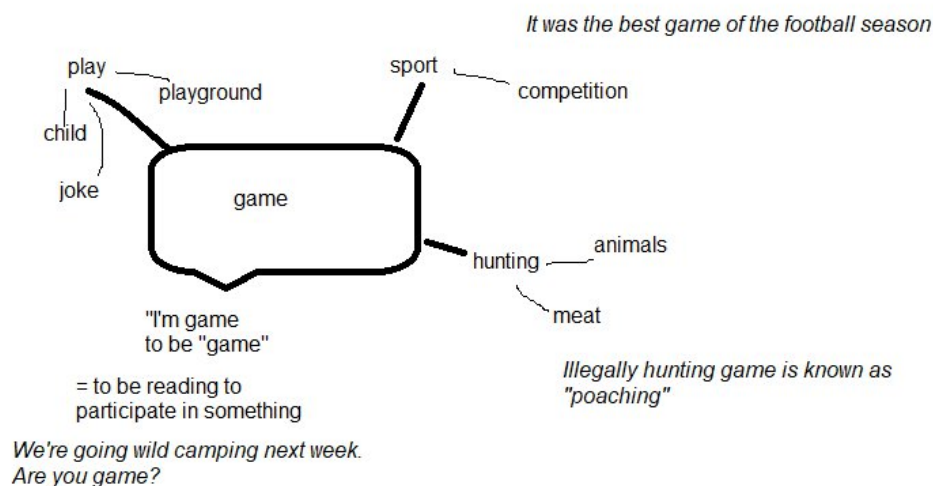
☐ NEW BRICK ☐ Revamp of existing brick:memorising vocabulary.....

BRICK CREATED BY :	Rebecca
BRICK REVIEWED BY :	Carole

Menu	Sub-topic	KEYWORDS (for the search engine: 3-5 words)
☐ Everyday Communication ☐ Specialist Communication ☐ Professional Communication ☒ Learning Focus	☐ Existant ☐ To be created	vocabulary memory learning strategies

Content	Teacher's comments for David
 <u>Step 1: Introduction</u> LEARNING OBJECTIVES At the end of this brick you will be able to apply the techniques illustrated in this brick to help you to learn and retain new vocabulary. CONTENT You will ... 1) Reflect on your current learning methods, with the help of a short quiz 2) Watch a short video 3) Test the “word spider web” method of memorising vocabulary 4) Read an article and complete a listening comprehension quiz 5) You can explore the subject further using the resources provided if you wish TIME: 20 mins CEFR level: B1	
<u>Step 2: I start</u> Quiz Complete this short quiz to help you reflect on how you currently learn and memorise vocabulary.	PAS de bon reponse – tout est possible. Donc comment on fait pour le

1) Do you have a method for learning vocabulary? a) no – I’ve never thought about it b) yes – I have a method that I always use c) sort of – I’ve tried a few methods over the years 2) Which of the following methods have you tested? a) lists b) flashcards c) word webs/clouds d) examples in context e) none of the above 3) When I encounter a new word in English, I: a) translate it into my native language b) try to connect it with other words I know in English c) ignore it and try to do without it 4) How often do you revise the new words you have learnt? a) never b) only for class / for an exam c) I try to do it regularly d) Very regularly (every 2 or 3 days) until I can use them in an essay or a conversation FEEDBACK (to appear at the end of test) Learning and memorizing new words may seem like a huge task. Try not to feel overwhelmed. Take it one step at a time and enjoy the process. You can do this!	feedback ?
Step 3: I learn <i>I learn (option 3)</i> <i>Video (“watch&listen”)</i>  https://youtu.be/TZYOScgVc3g?si=WTM20YJn3LHEUBQv Listen to the beginning of the following video (0:00 - 1:16) and try to understand the meaning of “a word spiderweb”. What is it used for? [Page 2] This diagram illustrates the type of word spiderweb the speaker suggests. Does it look as you imagined?	<i>Same video as original brick, slightly changed text</i>



Step 4: I practice 1 – creating a word web



"Language work"

"play"

You are going to make your own word spiderweb using the word "play".

1) Write down the first words that come to mind when you think of the word "play". Remember it can have multiple meanings – consider this when shaping your "web" of words.

2) Note down any phrases or expressions you have heard that you can remember that use the word "play" – for example, "play on words", "play to win".

3) Look up the word "play" in an English dictionary, and note down some meanings you have not included. Add example phrases.

Possible online dictionary pages:

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/play>

<https://www.dictionary.com/browse/play>

4) Try to connect these meanings that are new to you, to words that you already know. Add these words to your spider web of words.

Taking the time to associate new knowledge with existing knowledge is an efficient method for remembering new vocabulary.

4) Choose one of the meanings of the word "play" that is new to you. Try to picture yourself in a situation where you would use this word. Imagine using it with your friends, family, or someone close to you. What could you be talking about? What would you say?

Example: *I went to see a play at the theatre. My favourite actor was playing the main*

Texte en zones de texte à apparaître dans une bulle apart « idée », lumière, je ne sais pas – avec une illustration Boostonaut ?

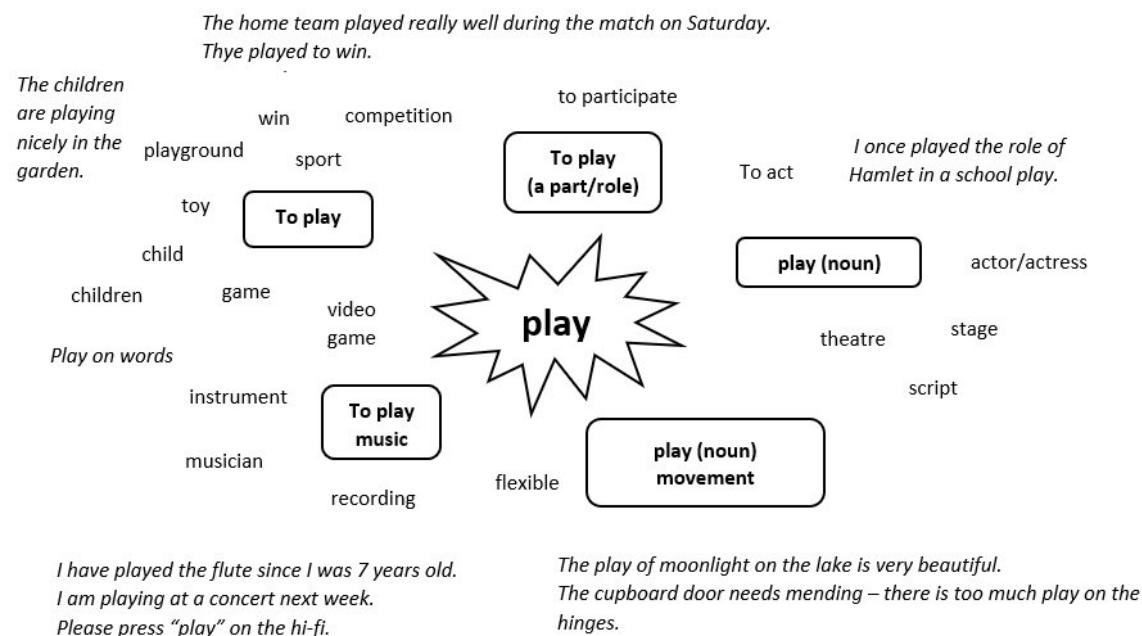
role. His latest film is playing at the cinema at the moment.

Trying to connect vocabulary to personal experience is a very powerful method for memorising. If you can bring in humour and/or emotions you are even more likely to remember it!

5) Write down your own sentences using the word “play” based on your own experience and/or imagination. Your brain is more likely to remember the words if they are relevant for you.

6) Repeat steps 5 and 6 for other meanings of the word “play”.

[Page 2] Does your word web look anything like this one? [Note – this diagram does not cover all possible meanings of the word “play” in English!]



Step 5: I learn 2 – further techniques to try

Always keep in mind that vocabulary can be learned/memorized using a variety of strategies. It is very important that you use more than one strategy to learn new words. Think of every strategy as an alternative road that leads you to the destination. Your brain needs more than one road to make sure it reaches the destination every time (i.e. remembers the words in the long run).

Here are some suggested strategies. Try them out and find the ones that work for you!

INLINGUA. 2019. ‘How To Learn Vocabulary In A Foreign Language - 12 Tried Ways’. Inlingua Washington DC, January 25. <https://idc.edu/blog/12-tried-true-ways-learn-foreign-language-vocabulary/>.

1) Read the following article and note down the 12 techniques mentioned in your own

Link

?

words. • Have you tried any of these methods? • Which methods can be connected to the “word spider web” method tested in this brick? • Which methods would you be interested in trying? 2) Test your understanding of the article with this short quiz. Q1: According to linguistics, “getting by” in a language is considered to need a vocabulary of around: a) 60 words b) 120 words c) 600 words (Feedback: this figure comes from research reported in the Telegraph in 2013). Q2: According to the article, the best way to learn a language is to: a) immersion – surround yourself with people speaking the language b) use visual cues – draw images to represent the new word c) use flashcards – put the target language on one side, the translation on the other (FEEDBACK: all three methods are mentioned, but “immerse yourself” is highlighted at the best) Q3: True or false: according to the article, you should never mix your target language with your native language. a) true b) false (FEEDBACK: the article suggests replacing native words with foreign ones when speaking, to help you learn the word in a familiar context. ATTENTION: mixing languages is not always recommended, particularly with young children trying to pick up more than one native tongue in early life). Q4: True or false: you should only read high quality literature and long texts in the target language. a) true b) false (FEEDBACK: the article suggests reading “anything and everything”). Q5: To improve communication, it is better to focus on learning: a) parts of words (prefixes and suffixes) b) individual words c) clusters of words, in phrases (Feedback: all three are mentioned as ways to learn vocabulary, but for ease of real communication, learning phrases and clusters is cited as a better approach)	reponse correcte en gras
Step 6: I practise 2 – words in context 1) Select a word or expression from the article or explanations of the previous section that is unfamiliar to you. Check its meaning in a dictionary, then use the method from “I practise 1” to build your own spider web of words around the word. • check its meaning or meanings	

• connect it to words and phrases you already know • Imagine a scene from your everyday experience in which you could use the word. Try to associate people, place, sights and smells with the scene in your imagination. Suggested words from the text: critical – immersion – cue – substitute – cluster Write a text short text describing the scene, including any dialogue.	
Step 7: I do  Reflection Write a short paragraph explaining how this brick made you reflect on your learning strategies. Start by making a list of the strategies mentioned in the brick, then think about the following questions: • Which ones do you think would work for you? • Which ones did you try in the past and did not work? • Now can you explain why they didn't? Be prepared to submit this writing if required to by your teacher.	
Step 9: I share  “groupclass” Be prepared to discuss with your classmates: 1) your reflection from the “I do” section 2) any new words you have learned in this brick. Be ready to share the scene(s) you wrote about in “I practise 2”.	
Step 10: I want more • Watch the rest of the video from “I learn 1” and connect the strategies mentioned to others you have seen during this brick. https://youtu.be/TZYOScgVc3g?si=WTM20YJn3LHEUBQv • ‘How To Learn Vocabulary: 15 Effective Ways And Techniques’. 2025. Blog Estudyme. Estudyme, May 28. https://estudyme.com/en/how-to-learn-vocabulary/ https://estudyme.com/en/how-to-learn-vocabulary/	
Step 11: For teachers Encourage the students to try out other methods mentioned in the article or the video. Reading and listening – this can also be explored as part of work on listening or reading comprehension strategies. Provide examples of podcasts with transcripts, or texts that	Cachée pour les étudiants

can be used with text-to-speech software.

<https://enchantedesl.com/ultimate-esl-vocab-teaching-guide-revolutionary-system/>

Will. (n.d.) Ultimate ESL Vocab Teaching Guide: Revolutionary System – Enchanted ESL. Accessed 17 September 2025. <https://enchantedesl.com/ultimate-esl-vocab-teaching-guide-revolutionary-system/>.